

Menu Translation App: LingoBite

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Elevator Pitch

LingoBite

Explore New Cuisines Fearlessly



LingoBite

When our team had our brainstorm session, the idea of a menu translation app caught our attention because we all share experiences of being indecisive at restaurants due to language barriers. While translation apps and AIs like Chat GPT exist, we find that they are often inaccurate and unable to provide relevant information in the right context.

Travelers and food lovers often feel overwhelmed when ordering food in foreign languages, mispronouncing and misunderstanding dishes can also lead to embarrassments, which ruin the experience. With LingoBite's help, users will be able to make confident and informed orders anywhere in the world.



Early Research

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1. User
Interviews

2. Empathy Map

3. Journey Map

Key Findings From User Interviews

Went by context clues + images helped

they're too shy to ask if they don't understand the language

menus with no pictures of the dishes makes it hard to choose a dish the user likes

Asked around for help

takes a long time to order in a different language

Mentioned how it's difficult for them to recognize dishes because of the names since sometimes they aren't related

Searched the dish on the internet/ used AI

Important Quotes from User Interviews

"If there were more pictures and other resources I would have ordered something more to my preference, but I was just not feeling like putting in the energy into making decisions."

"It would be nice if there were clear pictures and translations for every item."

"You asked the right person. Today... very difficult for us to recognize the dishes."

"What made understanding the menu difficult were the language barrier, no pictures, no descriptions and hard to make inferences, sometimes it is hard to tell what the ingredients are even when there are pictures provided, and only the pictures of the most popular food are offered so it was hard to make well informed choices."

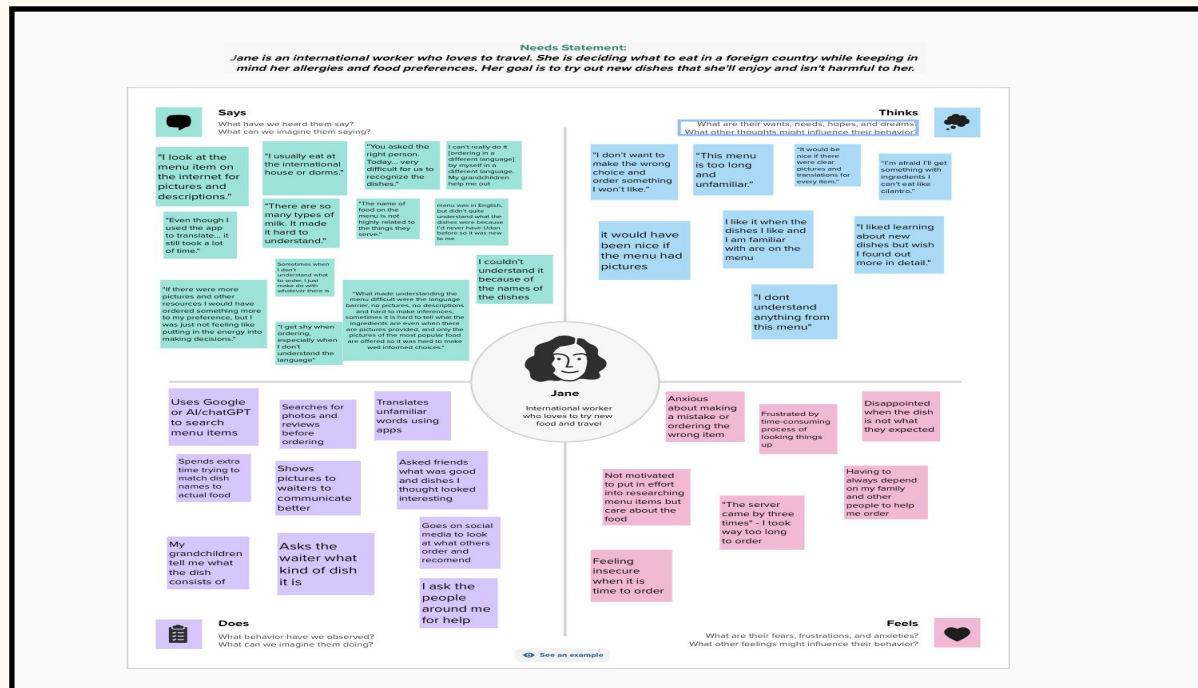
Sometimes when I don't understand what to order, I just make do with whatever there is

"I look at the menu item on the internet for pictures and descriptions."

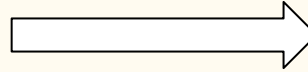
"I don't want to make the wrong choice and order something I won't like."

Empathy Map

Persona: Jane, an international worker who loves to try new food and travel

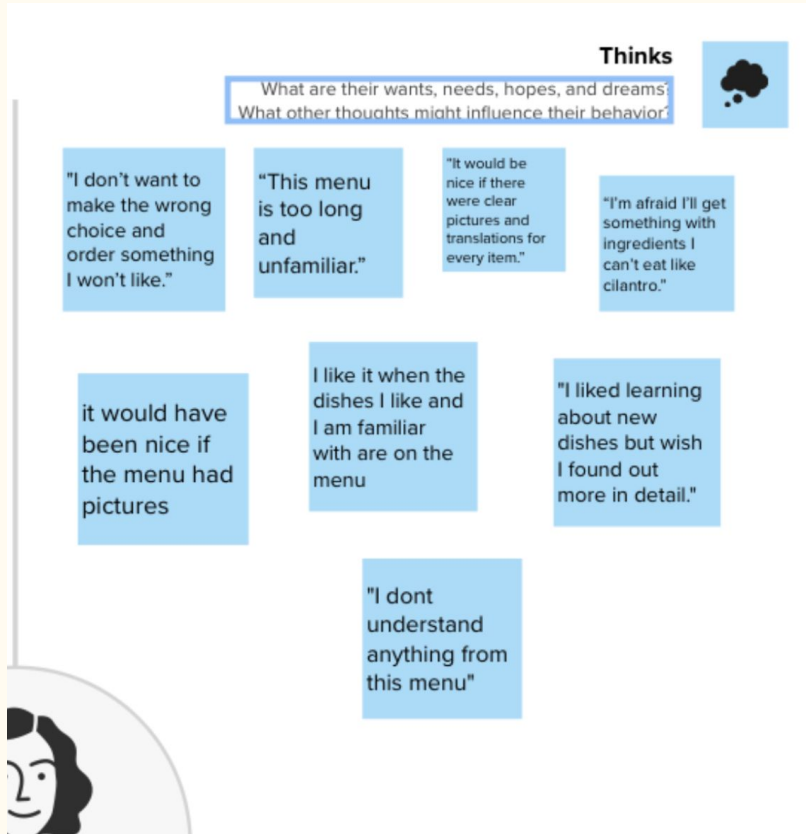


Empathy Map - A closer look



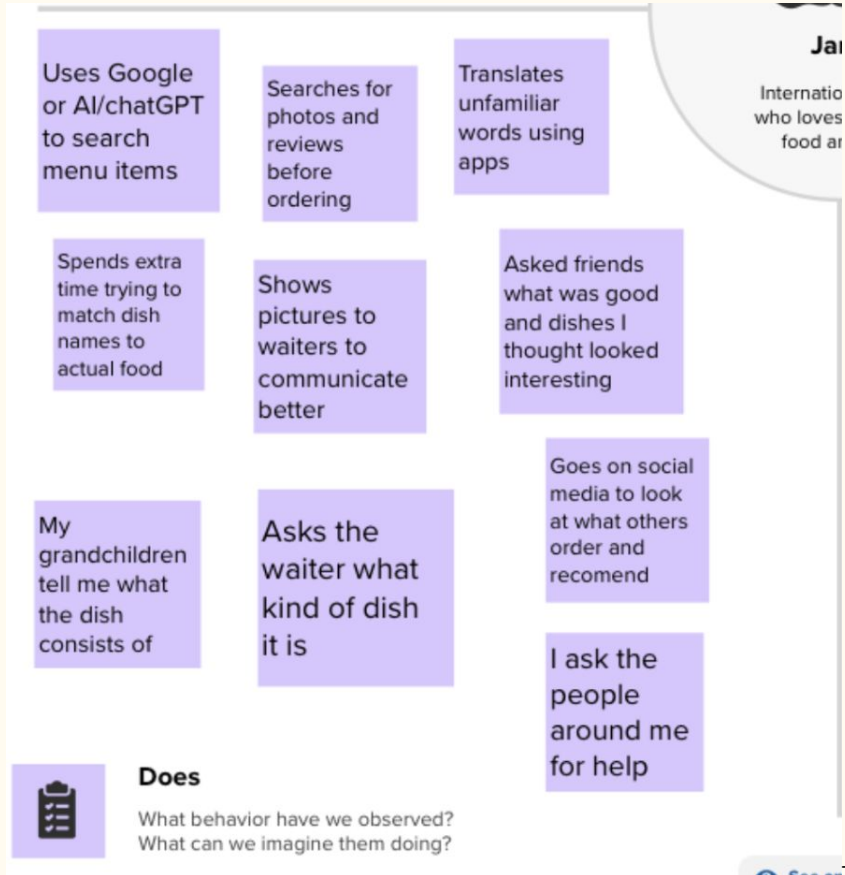
- No pictures/ can't recognize dishes → add images using AI/extract images from google so that our app will provide images for every dish
- Too shy/hesitant → feature that translates the menu for them in the language they understand + images to help them feel more confident before ordering

Empathy Map - A closer look



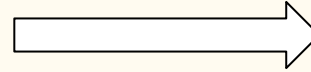
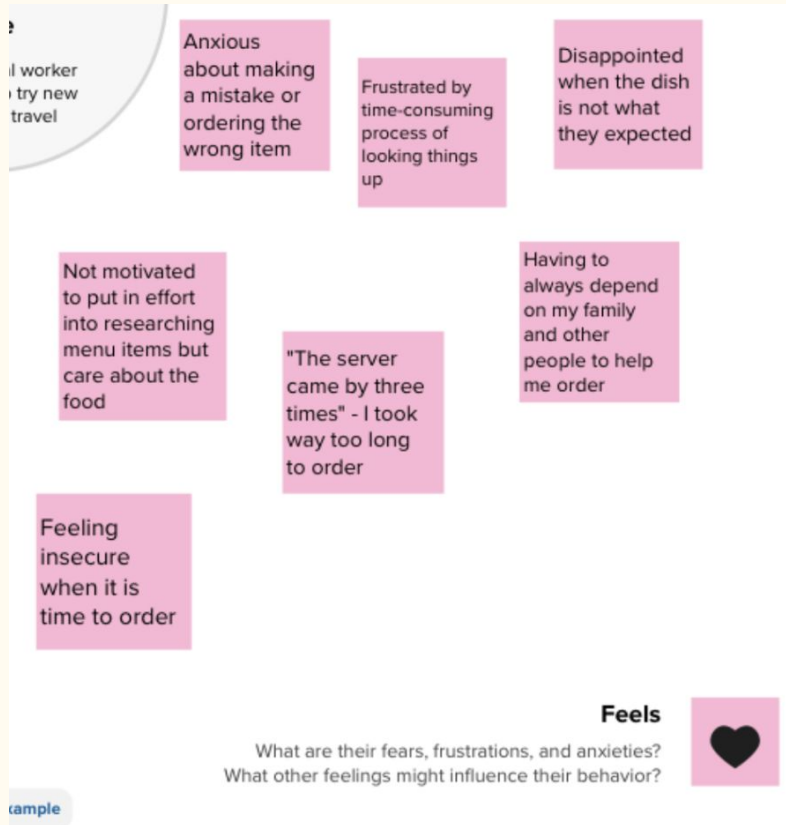
- Along with an image, the page will list out the ingredients of the dish
- Will help the user in ordering the correct dish

Empathy Map - A closer look



our app strived to combine all of the common things that people do

Empathy Map - A closer look

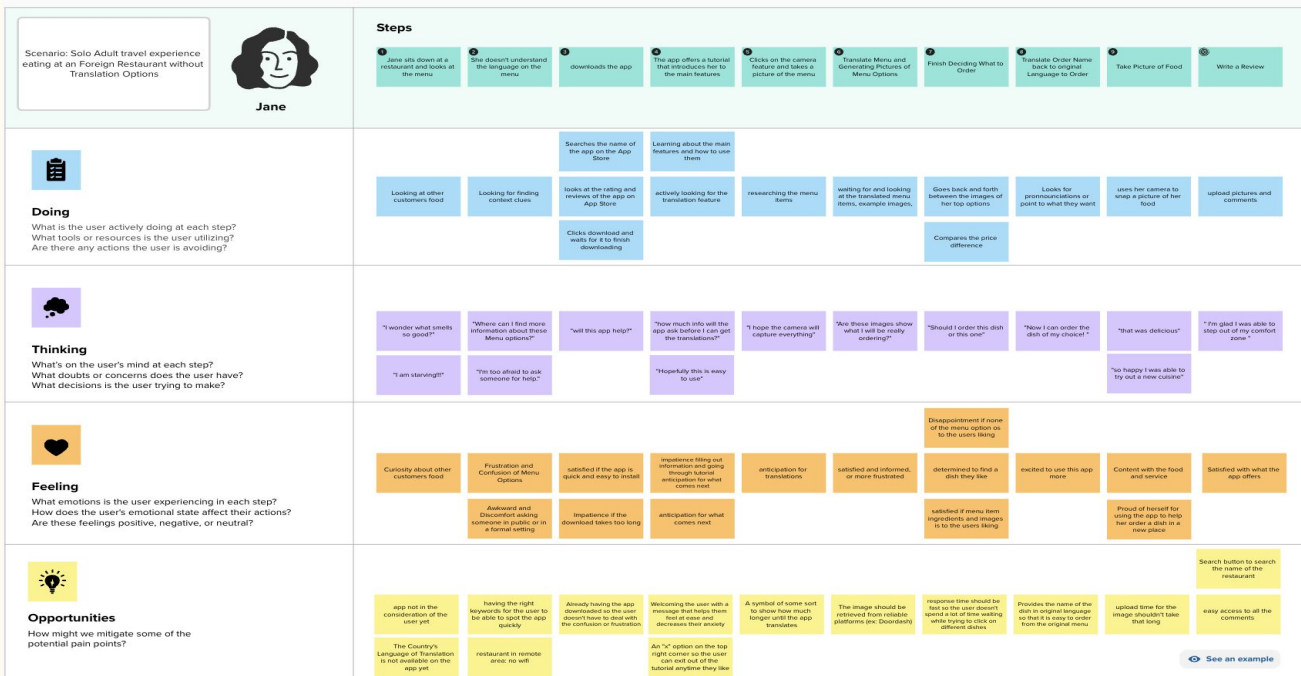


Our app should help users feel more comfortable, relaxed, independent

- App design should be easy & simple to navigate

Use this area to notestorm the steps in the your users' process (i.e. what are the steps they will need to complete to accomplish their goal using your app?). Write these steps down, discuss and rearrange them until you have a refined process that will go into your journey map below.

Jane is an international worker who loves to travel. She is deciding what to eat in a foreign country while keeping in mind her allergies and food preferences. Her goal is to try out new dishes that she'll enjoy and isn't harmful to her.



Journey Map Pain Points

- “Social” aspect to give the idea of a community → Add a search button to search name of restaurants
- To help the user order the dish in the original language → ability to go back and forth between the two languages while looking at the details of a dish → translation button

Recently Translated

🔍 search





Wireframe Walkthrough

LingoBite: App Description

A menu translation app designed to help people understand restaurant menus written in foreign languages. Whether their traveling abroad or exploring local restaurant, our app instantly translates dishes and provides useful information. Helping users to make confident and informed decisions in eating out.

UI Flow



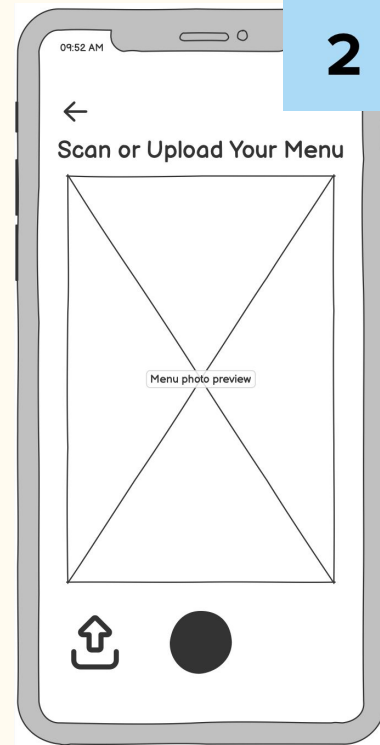
1

To the left is the home screen of our menu translation app.

- Users can search local restaurants for existing menus



The camera icon, circled in red, is used for restaurant menu translation. 17



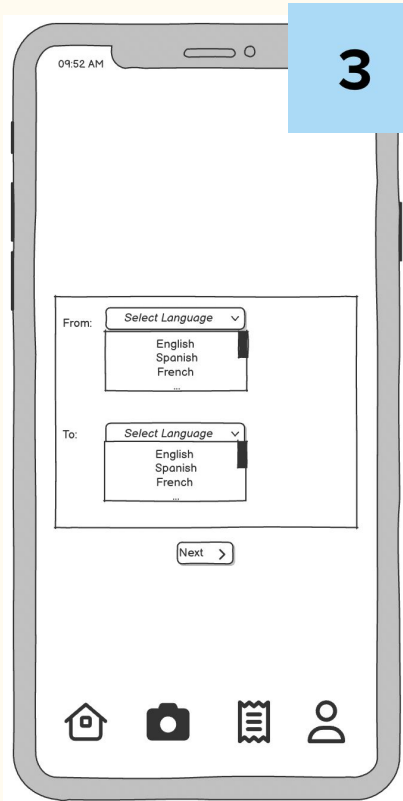
2

● On the camera page users can take a photo of a menu using the button.



The upload option allows them to select existing images from their gallery.

UI Flow

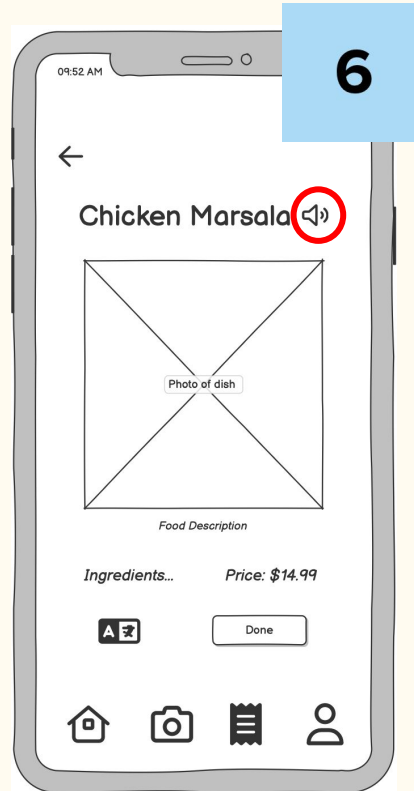
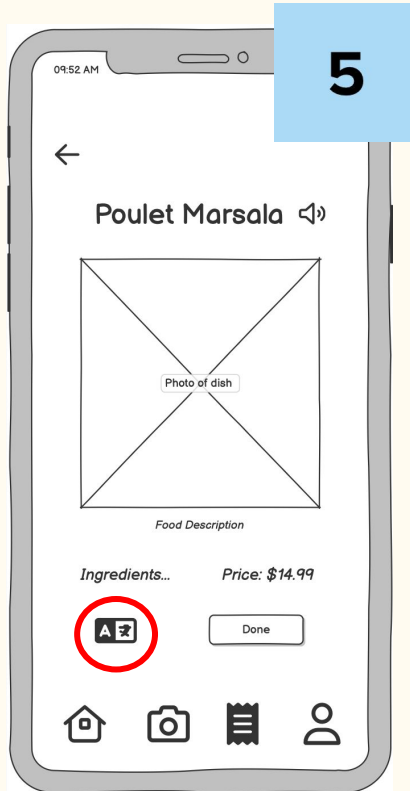


Once a menu is uploaded and a language is selected, the translation begins



After translation, users are taken to this overview page. Here, all the dishes are listed in the translated language in a clear, scrollable format. Each dish can be tapped to learn more.

UI Flow



A translation toggle lets users switch between the translated and original language.



The audio feature lets users listen to the translation.

Food Description

Food Lovers' Introduction

Ingredients...

More generally, is for those with allergies and food preferences.



Critique & Feedback

Peer Critique/User Feedback

According to peer critiques and user feedback, the app design is clear and easy to understand with reviewers praising how the icons, layout, and flow make it quick to recognize the app as a menu translation tool. The most valued features were the favorite dishes and view history section. Others mention how the feedback mechanisms such as the pop-ups and the signifiers and affordances such as the camera section along with the scroll bar clearly conveyed their functions. Overall, the reviewers felt that the app design was effective in communicating the app's purpose and functionality, highlighting that the UI flow is accessible to both technical users and non-technical individuals such as older adults or non-native speakers.

However, some critiques mention areas where the app design can be improved such as the profile page where the buttons on the screen might cause confusion. The process to delete items also was not clear enough. Users recommended involving check marks or animations to notify changes that users made. Individuals that have been interviewed mention minor issues such as how certain features don't have much discoverability which might be difficult for non-native speakers. Overall, we took these critiques into consideration when improving our app design.



Conclusion

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What Went Well/Not Well

- Our flow was straight forward, with little confusion
- We had a learning curve with Balsamiq which took a while to learn

What We Learned

- As a team, it is best to be communicative, and it is better to hear the bad news early.
- Having meetings really helped everyone's motivation and involvement with the project. Once everyone knew each other, we became a lot more open in expressing our ideas.
- Using signifiers that people were familiar with is very helpful
- Empathy and Journey Maps really helped with storytelling for users.

Future Developments

- Make buttons actionable
- Add more features, for example, adding a currency exchange option during translation
- Turn this project into a case study for our portfolios



Thank You!
